

CONTRACTS MODULE · LESSON: CDRLS AND DIDS

Section F Excerpt: Contract Deliverables Requirements List

Example Task Order: Distributed Network Support Operations (DNSO)

This is a real excerpt structure taken from a Cost-Plus-Award-Fee Task Order's deliverables section, with all identifying details replaced. It shows exactly how a CDRL is written into a contract: what's delivered, how often, and which SOW subtask it traces back to.

What a CDRL actually is

A Contract Data Requirements List (CDRL) entry is a single line that answers four questions: what is being delivered, who has to deliver it, how often, and what format it must take. Each CDRL usually points back to a Data Item Description (DID): a DoD-standard template that defines the required content and structure for that deliverable type. You almost never see 'DID' spelled out in a Task Order. Instead you'll see language like the deliverables table below, tied to specific SOW subtasks.

Section F Deliverables Table (excerpt)

DEL #	DELIVERABLE TITLE	TRACES TO SOW	FREQUENCY	FORMAT
1	TO Management Portal	Task 1, Subtask 1	NLT 60 days after award	Web-based tool
2	Program Management Plan (PMP)	Task 1, Subtask 2	At award; updated annually	MS Word / PDF
6	Kick-Off Meeting Minutes Report	Task 1, Subtask 3	Within 5 days of kick-off	MS Word / PDF
8	Technical Direction Letter (TDL)	Task 1, Subtask 4	As required	Section J template
13	Monthly Status Report (MSR)	Task 1, Subtask 6	Monthly, 10th calendar day	Section J template
17	Trip Reports	Task 1, Subtask 8	Within 10 days of trip completion	Section J template
20	Transition-In Plan	Task 2, Subtask 1	At kick-off or within 5 days of TDL	MS Word / PDF
22	Pre-Deployment Site Survey (PDSS)	Task 3	As required	MS Word / PDF
26	Platform & System Documentation	Task 4	Due when equipment delivered	Vendor manuals / specs
30	Concept of Operations (CONOPS)	Task 5	As required	MS Word / PDF
37	Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)	Task 6	As required	MS Word / PDF

Acceptance & Rejection Timeline

This is the mechanical clock every CDRL runs on. Memorize this pattern. It repeats across nearly every federal services contract:

STEP	ACTION	TIMEFRAME
1	Contractor submits deliverable	Per Section F due date
2	Government reviews and provides written acceptance, comments, or rejection	15 workdays from receipt
3	If comments/rejection issued, contractor incorporates changes and resubmits	10 workdays from Government comments
4	If non-conforming, contractor corrects deficiency or notifies Government of delay reason with a corrective action plan	10 workdays from rejection notice

Unresolved non-conformance doesn't just sit there. It gets documented in the award fee determination report and directly reduces the fee the contractor earns for that period. This is the thread that connects CDRL performance to CPAF award fee scoring.

FROM LUCAS

The biggest mistake new PMs make with CDRLs: treating the 'Traces to SOW' column as decoration. It's not. If the Government ever asks why you're spending labor hours on something, your answer is always 'it maps to Deliverable #X, which traces to Task Y, Subtask Z.' Can't draw that line? Then you're probably doing unscoped work. And unscoped work on a cost-reimbursement contract is how PMs get fired.



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